



Channel Theory

Acupuncture Point Selection Strategies



Class Learning Objectives

By the end of the class, students are able to

- Describe the channel pathology
- Select points based on channel theory
 - Local points
 - Adjacent points
 - Distal points



General Functions of Channels

- Transport Qi and Blood throughout the body
- Connects and integrates the body
- Protect the body



Channel Pathology -1

Channel	Symptoms
LU	Distention, stifling sensation, or fullness of the chest, pain in the supraclavicular fossa, shoulder pain extending to the chest, hot palms, aversion to cold, numbness or pain along the channel
LI	Toothache, dry mouth, throat pain, nasal congestion, runny nose, nosebleed, swollen gums, swelling at neck, shoulder pain, numbness or pain along the channel
ST	Runny nose, nosebleed, facial paralysis, throat pain, swelling at neck, chest pain, swelling and pain at the knee joint, numbness or pain along the channel



Channel Pathology -2

Channel	Symptoms
SP	Tongue pain or stiffness, heaviness of the body, fatigue, stifling sensation at chest, epigastric pain, swelling of big toe, cold feet, difficulty standing up, numbness or pain along the channel
HT	Dry throat, chest pain, thirst with desire to drink, yellow sclera, arm pain, pain along the scapula, hot painful palms, feeling cold, numbness or pain along the channel
SI	Throat pain, swelling of the neck, inability to turn the neck, shoulder pain with pulling sensation, arm and scapula pain, feeling cold, numbness or pain along the channel.



Channel Pathology -3

Channel	Symptoms
UB	Headache, bulging eyeballs and pain, occipital stiffness and pain, backache, inability to flex thighs, yellow sclera, nasal discharge with blood, pain or numbness along the channel
K	Dry tongue, swollen throat, throat pain, pain in the heart region, Wei syndrome, cold feet, pain and heat of soles, feeling cold, numbness or pain along the channel
Pc	Palpitation, contraction and pain of the anterior aspect of arm and elbow, feeling cold, numbness or pain along the channel



Channel Pathology -4

Channel	Symptoms
SJ	Tinnitus, deafness, swelling and pain of the throat, sweating, pain of the outer canthus, facial swelling, feeling cold, numbness or pain along the channel
GB	Chest and hypochondrial pain with inability to turn waist, greyish complexion, outer canthus pain, headache, swelling and pain of the supraclavicular fossa, swelling below axilla, feeling cold, numbness or pain along the channel
LR	Backache with inability to bend forward or backward, inguinal hernia in men, swelling and distention of the central-lower abdomen, dry throat, greyish or pale complexion, feeling cold, numbness or pain along the channel



Point Selection

- Diseased channel
- Other associated channels
 - Internally – externally related channels
 - Connected channels based on channel qi flow
 - Eg Shoulder pain
 - LI 15 area, needle ST 38
 - SI channel involved, needle UB 57
 - SJ14 area, needle GB 34
 - Channels share the same name



Local Points

- Located on or in close proximity to the diseased area
- May follow a channel distribution or ashi point
 - Commonly used for pain, sense organ disorders or near diseased organ
- Needling:
 - Acute: Reducing at distal points; even on local points



Examples – Local Points

- ST 25 and REN 8 for diarrhea
- REN 12 for nausea
- REN 17 for chest tightness
- ST 29 for uterine disorders
- LI 20 for nasal issues
- UB 1 for eye disorders
- SI 19 for ear disorders



Adjacent Points

- Points that near the affected/diseased area
- Often used in combination with local points



Examples – Adjacent Points

- SP 10 + ST 34 + SP 9 + ST 36 for knee joint pain
- LI 14 or LI 16 for shoulder joint pain
- GB 21, SI 11 for breast diseases
- GB 14 + GB 20 for eye disorders
- SJ 5 for wrist joint pain



Distal Points

- Most frequently used method to treat disorders
- Deadman: “there are no points distal to the elbow or knees that don’t have an effect on the head, chest and abdomen.”
- Channel trajectory – choose points from the diseased channel
- TCM diagnoses
- Needling:
 - Acute: often reducing techniques to remove excess
 - Chronic: local points combine with distal points



Examples – Distal Points

- Diseased channel
 - GB channel Temporal Headache – GB 43
 - Frontal Headache – ST 41
 - Vertex Headache – LR 3
- Associated Channel
 - Eg. GB channel Temporal Headache
 - LR 3, SJ 5



References

- Deadman, Peter, Mazin Al-Khafaji, Keven Baker. A Manual of Acupuncture. 2nd ed. East Sussex, England: Journal of Chinese Medicine Publications, 2007.
- Maciocia, Giovanni. The Practice of Chinese Medicine: The Treatment of Disease with Acupuncture and Chinese Herbs. 2nd ed. New York: Churchill Livingstone, 2007.
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